

Mercer Med Tech — IT Asset Distribution, Ownership & Return Policy

NJDOL Digital Literacy Training Program · Contract Digital Literacy Training-MMT-2026-06

Version 2.1 · September 28, 2026 · Replaces the August 2026 draft · Submitted for NJDOL review

1. Purpose

This policy sets out how Mercer Med Tech (MMT) issues, tracks, transfers and recovers IT assets bought with program funds. NJDOL advised on August 12, 2026 that laptops may be loaned or given to participants to own, provided a written policy explains distribution and return. Under this policy, a participant keeps their laptop after completing the program and keeping a job for 90 days, the retention period the contract uses to measure success.

2. Assets Covered

- Laptops running Windows 11, with charger
- Wi-Fi hotspots and their data service
- Peripherals issued with a laptop, such as a mouse or headset
- LMS (Moodle) accounts
- Microsoft or Google accounts and subscriptions
- Other digital tools required for training

3. Who Receives a Laptop

- Every enrolled participant receives a laptop once their Individual Employment Plan (IEP) is signed and before their first day of training.
- A hotspot is also issued when the IEP records that the participant has no reliable home internet. It is returned when the participant starts work or at exit, whichever comes first.
- No device is issued before the IEP is signed.

4. Distribution Procedure

- The participant signs the **IT Asset Agreement Form**, which explains the loan period, the two conditions for ownership in section 5, and the return rules.
- The IT Services Coordinator records the device in the inventory log: asset tag, make, model, serial number, purchase date, cost, condition and the participant it is issued to.
- The participant receives the laptop, charger, any peripherals and written instructions.
- LMS and Microsoft accounts are activated and the participant signs in on the laptop at orientation.

5. Ownership After Completion and 90-Day Job Retention

- The laptop is **on loan** from issue until ownership is decided. It remains MMT property and stays in the inventory log. Completers keep it on loan while they look for work and during their first 90 days on the job.

A participant becomes the owner of the laptop, its charger and peripherals when **both** conditions are met:

1. **Completion.** The participant finishes all training in their IEP, including the ETPL-listed credential course, as recorded in the participant file. Earning the credential is not required.
2. **90-day job retention.** The participant starts a job within 90 days of completing training and is still employed at the 90-day check, with the same or a different employer. This matches the contract's requirement that placed participants be retained for at least 90 days.
 - The Career Services Advisor verifies employment at the 30-, 60- and 90-day checks the contract already requires, using a pay stub, an employer letter or direct confirmation from the employer. The 90-day verification is recorded in the participant file.
 - If a job ends before the 90-day check, the participant keeps the laptop on loan while job searching, provided they start a new job within 30 days. The 90-day count then restarts with the new job.
 - Once both conditions are verified, the IT Services Coordinator helps the participant save their files to a personal account, removes MMT accounts and settings, and confirms the laptop works under the participant's own sign-in.
 - The participant, the IT Services Coordinator and the Career Services Advisor sign the **Laptop Ownership Transfer Form**. The inventory log is updated to "transferred to participant" with the date.
 - Once NJDOL approves this policy, transfers made under this section need no separate approval. MMT lists each transfer, by asset tag and serial number, in its monthly report to NJDOL.
 - If a participant's 90-day check cannot be completed before the contract ends on January 30, 2028, MMT will ask NJDOL how to handle those laptops before closeout.
 - Hotspots are never transferred. Their data service ends when they are returned.

6. Return Procedure

The laptop, charger and peripherals must be returned when a participant:

- withdraws or is exited from the program without completing it
- does not start a job within 90 days of completing training
- loses a job before the 90-day check and does not start a new job within 30 days
- is asked to return a device for repair or replacement

Hotspots are returned by every participant when they start work or at exit, whichever comes first.

- The IT Services Coordinator inspects the device and the participant signs the Return Confirmation Form.
- Returned laptops are reset and reissued to a later participant.

- If a device is not returned, MMT contacts the participant by phone, text and mail. A device still missing after 30 days is recorded as unrecovered and reported to NJDOL in the next monthly report.

7. Lost, Stolen or Damaged Devices

- Participants report a lost, stolen or damaged device within 48 hours.
- A theft is documented with a police report or the participant's signed statement.
- Replacement decisions are made case by case, using the program's replacement reserve. Participants are not charged for normal wear.

8. Use and Privacy

- Loaned laptops are for training, job search and related personal use.
- MMT installs Windows and security updates during the loan and may lock a device reported lost or stolen.
- MMT does not monitor participants' personal activity on the laptop.

9. Software and Accounts

- LMS and Microsoft or Google accounts provided by MMT are deactivated at exit. Access is restored only if the participant re-enrolls.
- Before exit, participants are shown how to keep their work in a personal account, since MMT accounts end at exit.

10. Purchasing

- Devices are bought in step with enrollment, never in bulk. Each purchase covers participants enrolled or confirmed for the next cohort, plus a small replacement reserve.
- Costs are charged to the Technology line of the approved budget, which allows \$1,000 per participant for a laptop, hotspot and peripherals.
- Purchasing follows the contract's procurement standards.

11. Records and Compliance

- MMT keeps a current inventory of all equipment worth \$250 or more, as required by the contract's Property clause and New Jersey Treasury Circular 19-12.
- The IT Asset Agreement, Laptop Ownership Transfer, Return Confirmation and employment verification records are kept in the participant file for seven years after the final expenditure report, or longer if an audit or claim is open.
- The inventory log is available to NJDOL on request.